Remote and Hybrid Working Policy

Policy owner	Director of People	**Approved**	15 September 2026
Applies to	All employees	**Next review**	September 2028

I. Purpose

This policy explains when employees may work away from an Association office and what both sides can expect when they do. It replaces the interim arrangements introduced in 2021.

II. Scope

The policy applies to all employees, including those on fixed-term contracts. It does not apply to agency workers or contractors, whose arrangements are set by their own agreements.

III. Definitions

Base location — The office named in the employee's contract, where they work when not working remotely.

Hybrid worker — An employee who regularly divides their working week between home and their base location.

Remote worker — An employee whose contract names their home as their place of work.

Core hours — 10:00 to 15:00, Monday to Friday, when all employees should be available.

IV. Eligibility and requests

4.1 Any employee who has completed their probation period may ask to become a hybrid worker.

4.2 A manager will normally agree a request unless:

(a) the role requires the employee to be on site, for example:

(i) caretaking and grounds maintenance;

(ii) reception and face-to-face tenancy support;

(b) the employee's home does not offer a safe and private place to work; or

(c) the team would be unable to provide the agreed level of service to residents.

4.3 A decision must be given in writing within 28 days of the request.

4.4 An employee whose request is refused may appeal to the Director of People within 14 days.

V. Equipment and expenses

The Association provides the equipment that employees need to work safely at home.

Item	Provided by the Association	Notes
Laptop and headset	Yes	Remains Association property and must be returned on leaving.
Monitor, keyboard and mouse	Yes, on request	Delivered and collected by the IT service desk.
Office chair	After a workstation assessment	Up to £250 including delivery.
Broadband and electricity	No	A flat allowance of £18 per month is paid to remote workers only.

VI. Health, safety and data protection

Employees who work at home must:

- complete the online workstation assessment within their first month of hybrid working;
- keep residents' personal information out of sight of other members of the household;
- lock their laptop whenever they leave it, even briefly;
- report any accident or near miss through the usual incident form.

VII. Review

The Director of People will review this policy every two years, or sooner if the law changes. Employees and the recognised trade union will be consulted on any significant change.